



Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Title: Housekeeping – Emergency Procedures
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1. Purpose

This SOP outlines the procedures for responding to emergencies at Tamborine Mountain Glades, including fire alarms, medical incidents, and guest evacuations. It also details the specific roles and responsibilities of housekeeping staff during emergencies to ensure the safety of guests, employees, and property.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all housekeeping staff at Tamborine Mountain Glades. It covers procedures for various types of emergencies, including fire, medical incidents, and situations requiring evacuation.

3. Responsibility

All housekeeping staff are responsible for following this SOP during emergencies. Supervisors and managers are responsible for ensuring that all staff are trained on emergency procedures and that these procedures are followed during an emergency.

4. Procedure

4.1 Fire Emergencies

1. Responding to a Fire Alarm:

- **Immediate Action:**
 - When a fire alarm sounds, stop all work immediately and prepare to assist in the evacuation process.
 - If you are in a guest room or common area, calmly inform any guests in the vicinity about the alarm and instruct them to evacuate the building immediately.
- **Evacuation Routes:**
 - Guide guests to the nearest fire exit, avoiding elevators. Use stairwells instead.
 - Ensure that guests with mobility issues receive assistance in evacuating safely.
- **Communication:**
 - Use your radio or the designated communication tool to inform your supervisor and the front desk of your location and the status of the evacuation in your area.
 - Report any guests who need special assistance or who are unable to evacuate.

2. If You Discover a Fire:

- **Alert and Evacuate:**
 - If you discover a fire, activate the nearest fire alarm pull station immediately to alert others.



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- Evacuate the area and ensure that guests in the vicinity are also evacuating.
- **Contain the Fire (If Safe to Do So):**
 - If the fire is small and manageable, use a fire extinguisher to attempt to put it out, but only if you have been trained to do so.
 - If the fire cannot be contained, close doors behind you to slow the spread and evacuate immediately.
- 3. **Post-Evacuation Procedures:**
 - **Assembly Area:**
 - Once outside, proceed to the designated assembly area and remain there until further instructions are given by emergency personnel or hotel management.
 - Account for all housekeeping staff and report any missing persons to emergency personnel.
 - **Do Not Re-Enter:**
 - Do not re-enter the building until the all-clear signal is given by emergency personnel or hotel management.

4.2 Medical Emergencies

1. **Responding to a Medical Incident:**
 - **Assess the Situation:**
 - If you encounter a guest or staff member experiencing a medical emergency, assess the situation quickly. Check if the person is conscious and breathing.
 - **Call for Help:**
 - Immediately contact the front desk or use your radio to report the emergency. Provide clear details, including the nature of the medical issue and the exact location.
 - Request that emergency medical services (EMS) be contacted if the situation is serious or life-threatening.
 - **Provide Basic First Aid (If Trained):**
 - If you are trained in first aid, provide assistance within the scope of your training until professional help arrives.
 - Do not attempt to move the person unless they are in immediate danger (e.g., fire, collapsing structure).
2. **Stay with the Person:**
 - Remain with the person until help arrives. Keep them calm and provide reassurance.
 - If the person is unconscious and not breathing, and you are trained, begin CPR immediately.
3. **Communication:**
 - Keep the front desk and your supervisor updated on the situation and any changes in the person's condition.
 - Provide any information that EMS or hotel management may need, such as medical history if known or any observations you made.

4.3 Guest Evacuations

1. **Evacuation Procedures:**



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- **Calmly Inform Guests:**
 - In the event of an evacuation (due to fire, bomb threat, or other emergencies), calmly inform guests that they need to evacuate the building immediately.
 - Assist guests with locating the nearest exits and guide them to safety.
- **Assist Vulnerable Guests:**
 - Provide assistance to guests with mobility issues, elderly guests, or families with young children.
 - Ensure that these guests are given priority during the evacuation process.
- 2. **Securing the Area:**
 - **Close Doors Behind You:**
 - As you evacuate, close doors behind you to contain any potential hazards and prevent the spread of fire or smoke.
 - **Do Not Use Elevators:**
 - Guide guests to use stairwells instead of elevators during an evacuation.
- 3. **Post-Evacuation:**
 - **Assembly Area:**
 - Lead guests to the designated assembly area and keep them informed about the situation as updates become available.
 - **Account for Guests:**
 - Attempt to account for all guests from your assigned area and report any missing individuals to emergency personnel.
- 4. **Assisting Emergency Personnel:**
 - **Provide Information:**
 - Be prepared to provide emergency personnel with information about the location of vulnerable guests, the status of the evacuation, and any potential hazards you observed.
 - **Follow Instructions:**
 - Follow all instructions from emergency personnel and assist them as needed.

4.4 Specific Roles and Responsibilities of Housekeeping Staff During Emergencies

- 1. **Housekeeping Staff:**
 - **Guest Assistance:**
 - Assist guests in evacuating safely, providing guidance and support, especially to those who may need extra help.
 - **Area Inspection:**
 - As you evacuate, conduct a quick inspection of your assigned area to ensure that all guests have left.
 - **Reporting:**
 - Use your radio to report the status of your area and any issues to your supervisor or the front desk.
- 2. **Housekeeping Supervisors:**
 - **Coordination:**
 - Coordinate with the front desk, maintenance, and other departments to ensure a smooth evacuation.



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- **Communication:**
 - Maintain communication with housekeeping staff to receive updates and relay information to hotel management and emergency personnel.
- **Post-Emergency Debrief:**
 - After the emergency, conduct a debrief with housekeeping staff to review the incident, address any concerns, and identify areas for improvement.

3. Liaison with Emergency Services:

- **Provide Support:**
 - Be available to assist emergency personnel by providing access to guest rooms, utility areas, and any information needed for the response.
- **Ensure Documentation:**
 - Document the events as they unfold, including the response actions taken and the timeline of the incident, for future review and reporting.

5. Quality Control

1. Regular Drills:

- Conduct regular emergency drills to ensure that all staff are familiar with the procedures and can respond effectively in a real emergency.
- Drills should simulate different types of emergencies, including fire, medical incidents, and evacuations.

2. Review and Update Procedures:

- Regularly review and update the emergency procedures to reflect any changes in the hotel's layout, staffing, or local regulations.
- Incorporate lessons learned from drills and actual incidents to improve the SOP.

6. Safety Precautions

1. Personal Safety:

- Always prioritize personal safety during an emergency. Do not put yourself at risk to assist others—call for help and follow safety protocols.
- Use PPE, such as masks and gloves, when dealing with medical emergencies or situations involving hazardous materials.

2. Clear Exits and Pathways:

- Regularly check that exits and evacuation routes are clear of obstructions and that all emergency equipment, such as fire extinguishers, is easily accessible.

7. Documentation

1. Incident Reports:

- After any emergency, complete an incident report detailing the events, actions taken, and outcomes. Submit this report to hotel management for review.
- Include any observations or suggestions for improving the emergency response process.

2. Emergency Contact Information:



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- Ensure that all housekeeping staff have access to up-to-date emergency contact information, including the numbers for local emergency services and hotel management.

8. Training

1. Staff Training:

- All housekeeping staff must be trained on this SOP during their orientation. Training should cover all aspects of emergency response, including fire safety, medical emergencies, and evacuation procedures.
- Provide regular refresher training and conduct drills to keep staff prepared and confident in their ability to respond to emergencies.